THIS SEAT HAS A HEAD.

Advertising 2 - Crafting for a Social Cause

A media-innovation campaign addressing pillion helmet use on everyday two-wheeler journeys.

Design submission / English / 14 October 2026

This submission contains the campaign strategy, published research, three initial media concepts, selected creative route, finished prototype artwork, execution plan and presentation. The campaign has not been deployed. Audience testing and permissions are planned, not claimed as completed.

1. The cause: the overlooked second rider

Road safety is broad. This campaign narrows the issue to the person on the second seat of a motorcycle or scooter, particularly on an everyday journey that may feel too ordinary to warrant preparation. Its focus is not a new helmet product, distribution scheme, app or service. It is communication that reminds both people to put on and fasten their own suitable motorcycle helmets before a shared ride.

The proposed setting is a permissioned campus or residential parking area. The intervention appears only while the vehicle is stationary and before either person mounts. That setting is chosen for relevance and prototype feasibility, not because local non-use has already been measured.

2. Research: scale, behaviour and limits

National context

MoRTH's 2024 road-accident data, as reproduced in OpenCity's safety-device table and cross-checked against Hindustan Times reporting, records **14,652 passenger fatalities in the non-wearing-of-helmet category**, within **54,122 fatalities in that category overall**. The table concerns India in calendar year 2024. The original ministry table cells were not directly inspected for this submission; the reproduced cells and matching report were. These numbers establish reported scale, not that helmet non-use caused each crash or that every death could have been prevented. They are not Mumbai-specific, age-specific or short-journey statistics. [4]

Reproduced data inspected: OpenCity API, resource 828acbc5-3daf-4561-9e01-3fb850593eb5, records Category=Passenger and Category=Total, field No Helmet - Killed. See the source register for the complete URL. The two publications share the same underlying ministry dataset; they are not independent studies.

The useful behavioural finding

Mishra and colleagues studied **346 adult two-wheeler crash patients** at a tertiary-care hospital in eastern India, using data collected during March-December 2021. **35.7%** had used a helmet, while **334 patients, or 96.6%,** agreed that a helmet was essential. Short-distance travel and forgetfulness were associated with helmet non-use; pillion status was also associated with non-use. The study was published in 2025. [1]

The important distinction is between knowing that helmets matter and remembering or choosing to use one on a particular trip. However, this hospital sample is not a representative survey of India, Mumbai, all young adults or uninjured commuters. Its associations do not establish causation, and a prevention campaign's effect cannot be predicted from them. [1]

Safety rationale

WHO identifies correct helmet use as a protective measure and places it within a broader safe-system approach that also includes roads, speeds, vehicles and care after a crash. The campaign therefore makes no promise that

wearing a helmet prevents every injury or makes an unsafe ride safe. [1]

Government guidance promotes BIS-certified motorcycle helmets conforming to IS 4151:2015. The campaign recommends a well-fitting certified helmet and fastening its chinstrap, without using certification marks or implying institutional endorsement. [5]

3. Target audience and insight

Primary audience: adult driver-pillion pairs aged 18-30, such as students and early-career commuters, encountered while stationary before a shared ride in the selected private-parking setting.

Secondary audience: the driver arranging the shared journey, who can include the passenger's helmet in preparation and check that both people are ready.

The age range and setting are a practical strategic focus, not a subgroup prevalence finding. No difference in local behaviour by gender, income or trip length is asserted.

Research-informed creative hypothesis:

> On an ordinary shared ride, the second seat can become an afterthought. Put the reminder where the second person is about to sit.

This is the campaign's interpretation of the opportunity, not a participant quotation. The specific local reasons for non-use - forgetting, availability, fit, discomfort, social norms or other constraints - need to be checked rather than presumed.

4. Creative strategy

Problem to address: an important protection may be omitted at the moment an ordinary shared journey begins.

Communication objective: prompt the driver and adult passenger to check that each has their own suitable motorcycle helmet on and chinstrap fastened before departure.

Single-minded proposition: the person on the second seat needs their own helmet too.

Desired response: "Before we ride, both helmets on; both straps fastened." If a suitable helmet is unavailable, do not start the ride until a safe arrangement is made. The campaign does not offer a rental or distribution service.

Tone: direct, considerate and equal. Address the passenger as a person with agency, not as cargo or a burden on the driver. Avoid shame, gore, fake fines, fear of police and simulated emergencies.

Campaign idea: THIS SEAT HAS A HEAD. The physical second seat becomes the advertising placement and makes the otherwise generic word "pillion" personal: the head is yours.

5. Three initial media-innovation concepts

Concept 1 - The second-seat message: selected

Existing medium repurposed: the stationary passenger seat of a two-wheeler, used as a temporary, permissioned advertising location.

A reusable A6 campaign card rests on the pillion seat during a supervised, opt-in encounter. The headline reads **"THIS SEAT HAS A HEAD. YOURS."** The message meets its audience at the point where the second person is about to sit. The facilitator collects the card before anyone mounts.

The seat supplies the meaning and timing. The innovation is not the manufacture of a card or accessory: moving the same words to a generic wall would remove their immediate reference to the passenger's own place on the vehicle. No scan, sign-up, new platform, device access or long explanation is required.

Trade-off: the route only works with consent, supervision, suitable weather and complete removal of the card. It must not become unattended litter or a riding obstruction.

Concept 2 - The two-person parking slip: rejected

Existing medium repurposed: a parking receipt, normally recording one vehicle, redesigned to acknowledge two people needing protection.

This is a viable media thought, but precedent research found HDFC Bank and STUDDS' **The Helmet Receipt** campaign, reported in February 2026, using symbolic receipt-style slips for helmet awareness. A receipt execution would have a close existing precedent. It is therefore not the selected route. The campaign also rejects fake summons and implied enforcement. [1]

Concept 3 - The plus-one ride invite: reserve

Existing medium repurposed: a direct-message image or social Story encountered before a planned shared ride.

A two-position visual changes a casual ride invitation into a preparation cue: **"Bringing someone? Bring both helmets."** It can be shared through existing channels without a new app, bot or integration.

Trade-off: it is removed from the mounting decision, can be ignored as ordinary social content, and assumes a planning behaviour that has not been validated. It remains a reserve concept, not the hero intervention.

Selection rationale

Concept 1 is selected for the closest relationship between passenger, placement and action, with a modest physical prototype. Concept 2 loses on executional distinctiveness; Concept 3 loses on proximity to the decision. This is a qualitative creative choice, not a numerical effectiveness ranking or proof of global originality. A focused precedent review is not exhaustive legal clearance.

6. The final campaign system

Hero: A6 second-seat card

Headline: THIS SEAT HAS A HEAD. YOURS.

Supporting line: Pillion passengers need a helmet too.

Action: Put on and fasten your helmet before you ride.

The card is 148 × 105 mm, with large type and a paired helmet illustration. Use the supplied print PDF at actual size. It is advertising collateral, not protective equipment, a seat cover or an accessory sold to riders.

Supporting A3 poster

Headline: TWO SEATS. TWO HELMETS. BOTH FASTENED.

Supporting line: Riding together? Check each other before you leave.

Guidance: Use a well-fitting BIS-certified motorcycle helmet.

Place it on an approved wall in the stationary preparation area, not where it competes with road signs or draws attention during a manoeuvre. It reinforces the same campaign; it is not a second social cause or a substitute for the hero media innovation.

Supporting social execution

Headline: WHO'S ON YOUR SECOND SEAT?

Action: Riding together? Both helmets on. Both straps fastened.

Safety line: Check before you ride. Never while riding.

The supplied vertical artwork and captioned storyboard extend the same paired visual system. They do not claim access to a vehicle's sensors or a live social-platform placement.

Visual language

Deep green provides the main ink; warm ivory is the base; acid yellow-green highlights the second person and action. Paired helmet illustrations establish equality rather than depicting an unprotected head in a crash. Plain text carries the meaning even without colour. There is no logo artwork, police insignia, certification seal, brand sponsor, crash image or third-party endorsement.

7. A 15-second captioned film

0-3 seconds: static view of a parked, unoccupied two-wheeler. Text: "One bike."

3-6 seconds: frame moves to the rear seat and the campaign card. Text: "Two people."

6-10 seconds: two helmet illustrations appear at equal scale. Text: "Two helmets. Both fastened."

10-15 seconds: a stationary, clearly labelled demonstration shows the card collected before mounting. End line: "Check each other before you ride."

No crash reenactment, unhelmeted riding, moving-vehicle filming, sudden sound, licensed music dependency or claim of completed filming. The HTML motion prototype demonstrates the sequence with captions and illustrated graphics; it is not live-action footage.

8. Production and deployment protocol

1. Obtain written venue permission and opt-in consent from the vehicle owner and adult participants. No location or partner is represented as already secured.
2. Use a parked vehicle in a clear preparation area, engine off and not in a live traffic lane. Adults may view the idea without agreeing to be photographed.
3. Place one card on the pillion seat only for the supervised encounter. No adhesive, wrapping, tied material, interference with controls or attachment to helmets.
4. Invite a brief look without blocking movement or demanding compliance. The facilitator is not an enforcement officer or an equipment inspector.
5. Collect and account for the card before anyone mounts or the vehicle moves. Never leave material on an unattended bike. Stop immediately if conditions become crowded, windy or unsafe.
6. If the second helmet is unavailable, do not stage an unsafe ride for the camera. Discuss preparation while stationary. Do not pressure someone to travel or expose them publicly.
7. If permission or safe supervision cannot be obtained, use the supplied illustrated context mockup as the submission demonstration and do not claim physical deployment.

The campaign does not address every structural barrier to helmet use or replace infrastructure, enforcement and affordable access to suitable equipment.

9. Feasibility and planning budget

A small prototype can use 12 reusable A6 cards, two A3 posters, a phone for documentation if consented, and volunteer time. No new technology is required.

Planning allowances: cards INR 180; posters INR 160; proofs/replacements INR 160; consent/tally sheets INR 50; contingency INR 150. **Total: INR 700.** These are assumptions, not vendor quotations. Labour, travel, taxes, permissions and helmets are excluded. Confirm actual print pricing and site conditions before spending.

10. Validation plan - not reported results

Comprehension first

Recruit 12 consenting adults, including people who sometimes travel as pillions. Show the hero card in the stationary context briefly and ask open questions before explaining:

- What is this message asking you to do?
- Who is it addressing?
- When should the action happen?
- Is anything confusing, accusatory or uncomfortable?

Proposed design gate: at least 10 of 12 independently identify passenger helmet use and pre-ride fastening. This is an operational threshold for revision, not a statistically validated benchmark. Revise if the "seat has a head" metaphor obscures the instruction, if anyone mistakes the card for a fine or requirement, or if the encounter feels coercive. Safety concerns trigger redesign regardless of the tally.

Optional small pilot

Only after permission and comprehension checks, compare aggregate pre-ride observations during similar baseline and campaign windows. Record paired departures, whether each person is wearing a helmet, and visible strap fastening. Mark uncertain observations as unknown; appearance alone cannot certify helmet standard, fit or protection. No plates, faces, names or individual tracking are required.

The primary process measure is the number of observed pairs where both helmets and fastened straps are visible, divided by pairs for which all those observations are possible. Also report unknown observations separately, participation/refusal counts and any operational problem. Small convenience samples and uncontrolled timing cannot establish causality, preventable deaths or lasting behaviour change. Do not invent results to complete a slide.

11. Assignment progression

14 OCT: narrowed cause, published research, insight hypothesis and three concepts.

21 OCT: work-in-progress artwork and prototype; undertake permission/comprehension work if feasible and record actual findings.

27 OCT: submit the selected campaign, presentation, research sources and execution materials.

28 OCT: present the issue / evidence / insight / media mechanism / action / validation logic.

These dates are reproduced from the brief, which does not specify a year. The date on this document is its preparation date, not an inferred assignment-year claim.

12. Conclusion

This campaign makes the second rider difficult to overlook by placing the communication on the second seat itself. It translates a general safety message into a specific pre-ride reminder without building a new service or relying on shock. Its design is complete as a demonstrable proposal; real deployment and effectiveness remain matters for permission, safe execution and honest testing.

Source register

All sources accessed 14 October 2026. Multiple publications repeating one dataset are identified as corroborating publication, not independent research.

- Mishra et al. (2025), *Factors associated with nonuse of helmet among motorcyclists sustaining road traffic accidents*. DOI: 10.4103/ijciis.ijciis_85_24. Primary article: https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12020946/ . Publisher full text: https://www.ovid.com/jnls/ijci/fulltext/10.4103/ijciis.ijciis_85_24~factors-associated-with-nonuse-of-helmet-among-motorcyclists . Methods and Results are the relevant sections.
- MoRTH, *Road Accidents in India 2024*, Table 3.3 / Annexure 37; original report copy: https://indiairf.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/Road-Accidents-in-India-2024.pdf . Reproduced data inspected: https://data.opencity.in/api/3/action/datastore_search?resource_id=828acbc5-3daf-4561-9e01-3fb850593eb5&limit=10 . Cross-check: Hindustan Times, 12 June 2026, https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/road-accident-deaths-increased-2-5-in-2024-from-2023-morth-report-101781204793385.html . Original ministry table cells not directly inspected.
- WHO (20 July 2026), *Road traffic injuries*, risk factors and safe-system sections: https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/road-traffic-injuries . Current fact sheet supports the safety rationale; it is not a study of this campaign.
- PIB (12 July 2025), *Helmet - More Than Just a Shell*: https://www.pib.gov.in/PressNoteDetails.aspx?NoteId=154872&ModuleId=3 . BIS standard identity cross-check: https://bis.gov.in/wp-content/uploads/2020/06/PM-IS-4151-JUNE-2020-REVISED.pdf . No blanket statement about legal exemptions is made.
- MediaNews4u (7 February 2026), *STUDDS Accessories and HDFC Bank launch The Helmet Receipt campaign*: https://www.medianews4u.com/studds-accessories-and-hdfc-bank-launch-the-helmet-receipt-campaign-to-promote-road-safety-and-preparedness/ . Cross-check: https://www.freepressjournal.in/mumbai/across-four-states-traffic-police-use-helmet-receipts-to-change-rider-behaviour . Used for precedent screening, not to substantiate effectiveness.